

Soul Food Break*fast



Created By: Dr. D Brown



Foundation in Christ | Youth Edition

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Break · fast - Month 1

Youth Edition



Theme:

Part I: Prayer, the First Resort

⁶In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. — Phil 4:6 (WEB)

COPYRIGHT

Soul Food Series – Bible Study Workbook © 2025

Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown, MBAE, MSIT, DD. All rights reserved.

Published by:

Overflow Harvest, LLC Springfield, Massachusetts, USA

No part of this publication may be reproduced, stored in a retrieval system, or transmitted in any form or by any means—electronic, mechanical, photocopying, recording, scanning, or otherwise—without prior written permission of the publisher, except as permitted by United States copyright law.

Soul Food Series and all related content, designs, and lesson formats are trademarks or service marks of Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown and are used under exclusive license through Overflow Harvest, LLC.

Usage for Churches & Small Groups

Churches and ministries are encouraged to purchase one workbook per participant whenever possible, to honor the labor and resources invested in this project. Permission is granted to reproduce brief excerpts (such as a single activity page, lesson question set, or prayer) for classroom or church use provided that:

- No fee is charged for the reproduced pages, and
- The following credit is included:

"Excerpted from the Soul Food Series by Dr. Shefa 'Dee' Brown. Used with permission."

Scripture Credits

Unless otherwise indicated, all Scripture quotations are taken from the World English Bible (WEB), which is in the public domain.

Disclaimer

This book is designed as a Bible study and devotional resource. It is not intended to replace professional counseling, pastoral covering, medical care, or legal/financial advice. Readers are encouraged to seek appropriate professional help when needed and to remain connected to a Bible-believing local church.

Youth First Edition: 2025

ISBN (print): 979-8-9940733-4-6

DIGITAL (pdf): 979-8-9940733-6-0

Printed in the United States of America

All rights reserved.

DEDICATION

This work is dedicated first and foremost to the Lord Jesus Christ—the original Disruptor, the Living Word, and the true Bread of Life. May every page point you back to Him.

To my son, Jafari, you pushed me to be a better mom and a teacher of the Word. Seeing your excitement and hearing how you and the youth I've taught rallied around the message—recalling with energy the impact of every lesson—is why this playbook exists. You are the reason I keep refining the craft.

To the student reading this: you aren't just a face in the crowd or a number to God. You are the guest of honor at His table. If you've ever felt like "leftovers" or found yourself stuck on a "loading screen" in life, know that you aren't too young to lead or too late for His promises. Don't settle for vibes when God is offering you Vision. You aren't just the future; you are the power of the church right now.

To the mentors, teachers, and real ones grinding behind the scenes—the ones praying for this generation and showing up even when it's hard: your "yes" is the soil this work grew from. Your unseen sacrifices are building a legacy that no book could ever fully describe.

Now, it's time to level up. This series is your foundation—designed to help you make prayer your first resort, navigate the "art of through," and move with the faith and foresight of a Kingdom builder. Keep dreaming, keep pushing, and stay hungry for the Word. The Shepherd is leading, and the win is already yours.

“Let no man despise thy youth; but be thou an example of the believers, in word, in conversation, in charity, in spirit, in faith, in purity.” — 1 Timothy 4:12 (KJV)

With warm regards,

Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown

Creator, SOFU Bible Study Series

QUICK START FOR LEADERS

Who this is for:

Pastors, ministers, small group leaders, Sunday school teachers, and facilitators using the Soul Food Series in any gathering (church, home, online, or community setting).

Session Length & Rhythm

- Recommended session time: 60–75 minutes
- Ideal pace: 1 lesson per week (or biweekly for deeper processing)
- Group size: 4–15 people works best.

Basic Flow for Each Lesson

1. Welcome & Prayer (5–10 min)
2. Appetizer (10–15 min)
3. Main Course: Bites + CST (30–35 min)
4. Dessert & To-Go Box (10–15 min)
5. Closing Prayer (5 min)

Tips for Leading Well

- Create a safe space; remind the group that what is shared stays in the group (w/ appropriate exceptions for safety).
- Honor time by starting and ending close to schedule.
- Let the Holy Spirit lead; the questions are a guide, not a cage.
- Model honesty and vulnerability.
- Invite participation, not performance.

Using Activities & Games

- Website Online Games
 - Use Trivia Mix-Up (Millionaire-style) and Tricky Testaments (Jeopardy-style) as Openers to review the previous lesson
 - or as Closers to reinforce the current one.
- Offline Games (no screens needed) include:
 - **StampTrek** (passport/stamp challenge)
 - **GRinCH Bingo** (prompt-based bingo play)
- **Rotate leadership on purpose:** invite youth or emerging leaders to **read questions, run the timer, track scores, award stamps, or lead a round**. This builds ownership, confidence, and facilitation skills.
- **Keep it moving:** choose **5–8 prompts max** per round, settle ties with a quick **Scripture check**, and end with a short prayer that connects the game back to the lesson.

Before Each Session

- Read the Background Text and lesson in advance.
- (Optional) Play the audio companion track.
- Pray for wisdom, discernment, and sensitivity.
- Ask God who might need extra encouragement that day.

You don't have to be a Bible scholar to lead. You just must be willing, teachable, and available. God will take care of the rest.

TABLE OF CONTENTS

Breakfast Series

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES	2
Part I: Prayer, the First Resort	2
COPYRIGHT	3
DEDICATION	4
QUICK START FOR LEADERS	5
TABLE OF CONTENTS	6
PROLOGUE	8
“Prayer for Divine Connection”	8
Introduction – “Prayer, the First Escort”	9
 Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther	10
Second <i>IS</i> the Best.....	10
 Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17.....	10
 Main Course	10
 Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14.....	10
 Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Esther 4:16.....	11
 Bite 3 – Purpose in the Palace, Est 8:7–8.....	11
 Dessert – God Works ALL Things Together, Rom 8:28.....	12
 BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon.....	14
 The Question That Unlocked a Legacy	14
 Appetizer – When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7	14
 Main Course	14
 Bite 1 – Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-11.....	14
 Bite 2 – God’s Response 1 Kings 3:10–12	15
 Bite 3 – Learning to Seek Wisdom Proverbs 2:1–6.....	15
 Dessert— The Legacy of a Wise Heart.....	15
 Activity – “Ask Big” (Youth).....	16
 BM1 – Lesson 3: Jesus.....	18

	Prayer as the First Resort.....	18
	Appetizer – Jesus Pulled Away to Pray Luke 5:15–16	18
	Main Course - The Mediator and the Model.....	18
	Bite 1 – “Lord, Teach Us to Pray” Luke 11:1–4.....	18
	Bite 2 – Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5.....	19
	Bite 3 – God Is Not Like the Unjust Judge, Luke 18:6–8.....	19
	Dessert — Prayer that Unites, John 17:20–21	19
	Activity – “First Response Check” (Youth).....	21
	BM1 – Lesson 4: Paul & Silas	22
	Faith in the Dark	22
	Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3	22
	Main Course – Power in the Praises.....	22
	Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24	22
	Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26	23
	Bite 3 – Sleepily Spared, Acts 16:27–30.....	23
	Dessert Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:31–34.....	24
	Activity – “Midnight Playlist” (Youth).....	25
	Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key.....	26

All scriptures are from the World English Bible (WEB) unless otherwise noted.

PROLOGUE

“Prayer for Divine Connection”

In the quiet of my heart, I seek Your face,
Elohim, Jesus Christ, fountain of grace.
Through ancient paths where prophets once trod,
I reach beyond the veil to touch my God.

Your Word, a lamp that guides through darkest night,
Transforms my weakness into holy might.
The Holy Spirit breathes where faith is born,
Three persons, one God—Father, Spirit, Son.

In perfect unity, the Trinity divine,
The Comforter within, Your presence mine.
The body of Christ, united as one,
Brother and sister beneath Your sun.

In family ties, both blood and spirit-bound,
Your kingdom's strength on earth is found.
When others stumble, empathy extends my hand,
With sympathy I weep, I pray, I stand.

The Spirit intercedes with groans too deep for words,
An advocate whose whispers are always heard.
For we are woven in Your love's design,
Each thread of mercy, wholly Thine.

Through sacrifice You broke sin's heavy chain,
Now in Your presence, I am born again.
The Spirit seals us, marked as heaven's own,
Until we stand before the eternal throne.

-By S.L. Doctor

Introduction – “Prayer, the First Escort”

“In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. — Phil 4:6 (WEB)

Before we can truly walk with God, we must first learn to talk with Him. Prayer is not simply a religious routine or a spiritual exercise—it is the first resort that ushers us into a genuine, living relationship with our Creator. From the very beginning, God desired fellowship with humanity, and prayer is the divine pathway through which that fellowship is restored and maintained.



When we pray, we are not informing God of what He does not know; rather, we are inviting Him into the center of our hearts, our situations, and our lives. Prayer is the language of dependence, the heartbeat of faith, and the foundation of intimacy with the Father. It is through prayer that our hearts are softened, our minds are renewed, and our will begins to align with His.

Jesus Himself modeled this truth. Before every major decision, miracle, and moment of ministry, He withdrew to pray (Luke 5:16). His life demonstrated that relationship with the Father was sustained through continual communion. If the Son of God needed prayer to remain connected, how much more do we?

Prayer is not the result of a relationship—it is the beginning of it. It is the open door into knowing God personally, hearing His voice, and walking in His purpose. As we begin this study, let us approach prayer not as a duty but as an invitation—a sacred escort leading us deeper into the presence and love of God.



SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY



Breakfast Edition Month 1 – Esther

Second /S the Best



Theme: Prayer, the First Resort



Background Text: Esther 1–4 (focus on chapters 2–4)



Key Verse: Esther 4:14 (WEB)

“For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. **Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?**”



Appetizer – Instead of, Est 2:17

“The king loved Esther more than all the women, and she obtained favor and kindness in his sight more than all the virgins; so that he set the royal crown on her head, and made her queen instead of Vashti.”

Esther didn’t grow up dreaming of being queen. She was a Jewish orphan, raised by her Uncle Mordecai, living in a foreign empire. But when Queen Vashti was removed, a search went out—and Esther was chosen. People might’ve seen her as “second pick,” but God saw her as **perfectly placed**.



Reflection Question

Have you ever felt like you were only chosen because someone else messed up or said no?



Main Course



Bite 1 – Mordecai’s Warning, Est 4:13–14

“Then Mordecai asked them to return this answer to Esther: ‘Don’t think to yourself that you will escape in the king’s house any more than all the Jews. For if you remain silent now, then relief and deliverance will come to the Jews from another place, but you and your father’s house will perish. **Who knows if you haven’t come to the kingdom for such a time as this?**’”

Mordecai tells Esther the truth:

- She can’t hide behind her crown.
- She has a choice—**stay silent** or **speak up** and risk her life.
- He also shows faith: even if Esther stays quiet, God will still send help from somewhere.
 - But she might miss her assignment.

Reflection Question

Where in your life might you be tempted to stay silent when you know God wants you to speak or act?

Bite 2 – Fasting Before the Move, Esther 4:16

“Go, gather together all the Jews who are present in Susa, and **fast for me**, and neither eat nor drink three days, night or day. I also and my maidens will fast in the same way. **Then I will go in to the king, which is against the law; and if I perish, I perish.**”

Esther doesn’t rush in on her own strength. She:

- Calls for **three days of fasting** (no food, no drink) for all the Jews in the city.
- Joins in the fast with her attendants.
- Decides: “If I perish, I perish.” That’s not drama—that’s surrender.

Youth Check-in (YES/NO):

Have you ever heard or did a fast before? Do you believe it can work (for you)?

Reflection Question

What’s one situation in your life where you need to **pray and maybe fast** before you make a big move?

Bite 3 – Purpose in the Palace, Est 8:7–8

“Then King Ahasuerus said to Esther the queen and to Mordecai the Jew, ‘See, I have given Esther the house of Haman, and they have hanged him on the gallows because he laid his hand on the Jews. Write also to the Jews, as it pleases you, in the king’s name, and seal it with the king’s ring; for the writing which is written in the king’s name, and sealed with the king’s ring, may no man reverse.’”

God flips the script:

- The enemy (Haman) is removed.
- Esther and Mordecai are given authority to write a new decree to protect their people.
- The same system that almost killed them is used to **defend** them.

Reflection Question

Have you ever seen God turn something that was supposed to hurt you into something that helped you or others?

Dessert – God Works ALL Things Together, Rom 8:28

We know that all things work together for good for those who love God, to those who are called according to his purpose.

Esther's story reminds us:

- You're not "just" a backup.
- God can use where you are, even if you didn't choose how you got there.

Reflection Question

Complete this: "God, if You put me **here**, help me to _____."

To-Go Box

- Your position is not an accident—it can be an **assignment**.
- Fasting and prayer prepare you for scary obedience.
- God can use your "second place" to bring a **first-class** victory for many people.

Write one sentence:

"Lord, help me see my current situation as **purpose**, not just **pressure**."

Prayer

"Lord, thank You for Esther. Help me not to see myself as 'second best' when You call me chosen and placed. Give me courage to obey You even when it scares me, and teach me to pray and fast instead of panicking. Use my life to help others, 'for such a time as this.' In Jesus' name, amen."

Personal Prayer Space

Write your own short prayer about where you think God has placed you "for such a time as this":

Activity – Quick Review

Fill in the blanks using what you've learned:

1. Esther became queen **instead of** _____.
 2. Her cousin who raised her was named _____.
 3. Mordecai told her she had come to the kingdom **for such a** _____ **as this**.
 4. Before going to the king, Esther asked the Jews to _____ for three days.
-



BM1 — Lesson 2: Solomon

The Question That Unlocked a Legacy



Theme: Choosing wisdom over “stuff”



Background Text: 1 Kings 3:3–14; Proverbs 2:1–6



Key Verse: 1 Kings 3:9 (WEB)

“Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this great people of yours?”



Appetizer – When God Says, “Ask Me for Anything”, 1 Kings 3:5–7

⁵ In Gibeon Yahweh appeared to Solomon in a dream by night; and God said, “Ask for what you want me to give you.” ⁶ Solomon said, “You have shown to your servant David my father great loving kindness, according as he walked before you in truth, righteousness, and uprightness of heart with you. You have kept for him this great loving kindness, that you have given him a son to sit on his throne, as it is today.

⁷ Now, Yahweh my God, you have made your servant king instead of David my father. I am just a little child. I don’t know how to go out or come in.

Solomon has just become king. God appears to him in a dream and basically says, “What do you want Me to give you?” Instead of pretending he has it all together, Solomon admits he is young and unsure, but he wanted to do right by God’s people.



Reflection Question

If God asked you, “What do you want Me to give you?” what would your honest first answer be?



Main Course



Bite 1 – Humble Heart of a King, 1 Kings 3:9-11

⁹ Give your servant therefore an understanding heart to judge your people, that I may discern between good and evil; for who is able to judge this great people of yours? ¹⁰ This request pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing. ¹¹ God said to him, “Because you have asked this thing, and have not asked for yourself long life, nor have asked riches for yourself, nor have asked the life of your enemies, but have asked for yourself understanding to discern justice,

Instead of asking for more money, more power, or revenge on his enemies, Solomon asks for an **understanding heart** so he can lead God’s people well. What he asks for shows what matters most to him.

Reflection Question

What do your prayers say about what you care about most?

Bite 2 – God’s Response 1 Kings 3:10–12

¹⁰ This request pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing. ¹¹ God said to him, “Because you have asked this thing, and have not asked for yourself long life, nor have asked riches for yourself, nor have asked the life of your enemies, but have asked for yourself understanding to discern justice, ¹² behold, I have done according to your word. Behold, I have given you a wise and understanding heart, so that there has been no one like you before you, and after you none will arise like you.

God is **pleased** with Solomon’s request. He gives Solomon the wisdom he asked for, and later adds riches and honor too. God loves when we want what He wants—especially when we ask for wisdom to serve others.

Reflection Question

Where in your life do you most need God’s wisdom right now—school, friendships, money, family, decisions?

Bite 3 – Learning to Seek Wisdom Proverbs 2:1–6

¹My son, if you will receive my words, and store up my commandments within you, ²so as to turn your ear to wisdom, and apply your heart to understanding; ³yes, if you call out for discernment, and lift up your voice for understanding; ⁴if you seek her as silver, and search for her as for hidden treasures: ⁵then you will understand the fear of Yahweh, and find the knowledge of God. ⁶For Yahweh gives wisdom. Out of his mouth comes knowledge and understanding.

Later, Solomon teaches others how to chase wisdom. Wisdom isn’t something you sit around and wait for—it’s something you **seek like treasure**. Real wisdom comes from God.

Youth Check-in

What is one practical way you can start “seeking wisdom like treasure” this week? (Examples: reading a chapter of Proverbs, asking an older believer questions, praying for wisdom every day.)

Dessert— The Legacy of a Wise Heart

Solomon’s story reminds us:

- What we ask God for shows what’s in our heart.
- God loves to give wisdom to people who want to use it His way.

Reflection Question

Finish this quietly: “Lord, help me want _____ more than _____.”

To-Go Box

- God isn’t just listening to **what** you ask—He sees **why** you ask.
- Wisdom is worth more than status or stuff.
- When you don’t know what to do, asking God for an **understanding heart** is one of the best prayers you can pray.

Write one sentence:

“God, please give me wisdom about _____.”

Prayer

“God, thank You for the way You answered Solomon when he asked for wisdom. Please forgive me for the times I chase stuff more than I chase Your heart. Give me an understanding heart to make good choices, treat people right, and honor You in my decisions. Help me to seek wisdom like treasure. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Activity – “Ask Big” (Youth)

Fill in the blanks from the lesson:

1. God appeared to _____ in a dream and said, “Ask for what you want Me to give you.”
2. Solomon asked for an _____ **heart** to judge God’s people.
3. God was _____ that Solomon asked for wisdom instead of riches or revenge.
4. In Proverbs 2, we are told to seek _____ like silver and hidden treasure.



BM1 – Lesson 3: Jesus



Prayer as the First Resort



Theme: Prayer as the First Resort



Background Text: Luke 5:15–16; Luke 11:1–4; Luke 18:1–8



Key Verse: Luke 18:1 (WEB)

He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up;



Appetizer – Jesus Pulled Away to Pray Luke 5:15–16

¹⁵ But the report concerning him spread much more, and great multitudes came together to hear, and to be healed by him of their infirmities. ¹⁶ But he withdrew himself into the desert, and prayed. Crowds kept coming. Needs kept growing. People wanted to hear Jesus and be healed. But instead of just doing more and more, Jesus **chose to pull away and pray**. When things got busier, He didn't pray less—He prayed **more**.



Reflection Question

When your life gets busier or more stressful, what usually gets cut first: sleep, fun, prayer, or something else?



Main Course - The Mediator and the Model



Bite 1 – “Lord, Teach Us to Pray” Luke 11:1–4

¹ When he finished praying in a certain place, one of his disciples said to him, “Lord, teach us to pray, just as John also taught his disciples.”

² He said to them, “When you pray, say,
‘Our Father in heaven, may your name be kept holy.
May your Kingdom come.

May your will be done on earth, as it is in heaven.

³ Give us day by day our daily bread.

⁴ Forgive us our sins, for we ourselves also forgive everyone who is indebted to us.
Bring us not into temptation, but deliver us from the evil one.’

The disciples watched Jesus pray and **wanted that**, not just a script.

Jesus gives them a pattern:

- Start with **who God is** (Father, holy, His Kingdom)
- Ask for daily needs
- Ask for **forgiveness** and help to forgive others
- Ask for help in **temptation**

Reflection Question

Which part of that prayer do you use most—praise, daily needs, forgiveness, or help in temptation? Which part do you usually skip?

Bite 2 – Don’t Quit Praying, Luke 18:1–5

¹ He also spoke a parable to them that they must always pray, and not give up, ² saying, “There was a judge in a certain city who didn’t fear God, and didn’t respect man. ³ A widow was in that city, and she often came to him, saying, ‘Defend me from my adversary!’

⁴ He wouldn’t for a while; but afterward he said to himself, ‘Though I neither fear God, nor respect man, ⁵ yet because this widow bothers me, I will defend her, or else she will wear me out by her continual coming.’

Jesus tells a story about a judge who doesn’t care about God or people. A widow keeps coming anyway, asking for justice. The judge finally responds—not because he’s good, but because she **doesn’t quit**. Jesus uses this to show: if even a bad judge listens to persistence, how much more will a **good God** listen to His kids?

Reflection Question

Is there something you used to pray about that you’ve stopped praying for because it took too long?

Bite 3 – God Is Not Like the Unjust Judge, Luke 18:6–8

⁶ The Lord said, “Listen to what the unrighteous judge says. ⁷ Won’t God avenge his chosen ones, who are crying out to him day and night, and yet he exercises patience with them? ⁸ I tell you that he will avenge them quickly. Nevertheless, when the Son of Man comes, will he find faith on the earth?”

Jesus makes the contrast clear:

- God is not like an unjust judge.
- God **hears** His people crying out day and night.
- The question isn’t “Will God answer?” It’s “Will we still have **faith** when He does?”

Youth Check-in:

What does it look like—for you—to “always pray and not give up” about one thing this week?

Dessert — Prayer that Unites, John 17:20–21

“Not for these only do I pray, but for those also who believe in me through their word, that they may all be one, even as you, Father, are in me, and I in you, that they also may be one in us; that the world may believe that you sent me.”

Even before the cross, Jesus prayed for us. He sought the Father for strength, direction, and surrender. That's the model: **prayer in the beginning, prayer in the middle, prayer at the finish.**

Jesus' life says:

- Prayer isn't just something we do **when all else fails**.
- Prayer is how we **breathe with God**—daily, honestly, persistently.

 Reflection Question

Finish this: "From now on, when I feel overwhelmed, I want to **pray first** instead of _____."

 To-Go Box

- If Jesus needed to pull away and pray, we definitely do too.
 - Prayer is simple: talk to God, listen, and keep coming back.
 - Not every prayer gets answered the way we expect—but **no prayer is ignored**.
-

 Prayer

"Jesus, thank You for showing us what real prayer looks like. Forgive me for the times I only pray when I'm desperate. Help me to come to You first—not last. Teach me to pray simply, honestly, and consistently, and not to give up when I don't see answers right away. In Your name, amen."

Personal Prayer Space

Write a short prayer about one thing you want to start praying about again:

Activity – “First Response Check” (Youth)

Fill in:

1. One thing that stresses me out: _____
2. My usual first response (be honest): _____
3. A new first response I want to try: **Pray before I** _____.

(Answers are personal; no key needed in the student book—only in your heart.)

BM1 – Lesson 4: Paul & Silas

Faith in the Dark

 **Theme:** Praise in Midnight Moments

 **Background Text:** Acts 16:16–34; Isaiah 26:3; Phil 4:6–7

 **Key Verse:** Acts 16:25-26 (WEB)

“But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone’s bonds were loosened.”

Appetizer – The Mindset is Everything, Isa 26:3

You will keep whoever’s mind is steadfast in perfect peace, because he trusts in you.

Although no one was promised the “Easy St” while spreading the Word of God, your trust that you have in him, no matter the situation is the setup for victory. God promises perfect peace to those who fix their minds on Him. His peace is not the absence of trouble, but a deep, enduring confidence in His unchanging nature.

Reflection Question

When has God given you peace when everything around you said panic?

Main Course – Power in the Praises

Bite 1 – The Test in Their Testament, Acts 16:22–24

²² The multitude rose up together against them, and the magistrates tore their clothes off of them, and commanded them to be beaten with rods. ²³ When they had laid many stripes on them, they threw them into prison, charging the jailer to keep them safely, ²⁴ who, having received such a charge, threw them into the inner prison, and secured their feet in the stocks.”

Paul and Silas helped set a slave girl free from a spirit that was controlling her. Instead of getting a “thank you,” they were:

- Stripped
- Beaten
- Thrown into the **inner prison**
- Locked in stocks

Oftentimes we don't hear an immediate 'thank you' for doing what is right. Our response shouldn't be based on what they do in return, but when he has called us to do – period. That's the test, our follow-through produces the testimony.

Bite 2 – The Jailhouse Rocked, Acts 16:25–26

²⁵ But about midnight Paul and Silas were praying and singing hymns to God, and the prisoners were listening to them. ²⁶ Suddenly there was a great earthquake, so that the foundations of the prison were shaken; and immediately all the doors were opened, and everyone's bonds were loosened."

God answers in a wild way:

- Earthquake
- Open doors
- Loose chains

It's amazing what can happen when you keep your mind stayed on Him (see Isaiah 26:3). Their voices turned a prison into a sanctuary, and their pain became a praise report. Sometimes your midnight melody becomes someone else's breakthrough song. **That's what made the jailhouse rock!** Certain songs, like "Holy Forever" by CeCe Winans, strengthen my heart when life feels heavy because they lift my focus off the problem and onto His power.

Reflection Question

What worship song or prayer brings you back to peace when life feels heavy?

Bite 3 – Sleepily Spared, Acts 16:27–30

²⁷ The jailer, being roused out of sleep and seeing the prison doors open, drew his sword and was about to kill himself, supposing that the prisoners had escaped. ²⁸ But Paul cried with a loud voice, saying, 'Don't harm yourself, for we are all here!' ²⁹ He called for lights and sprang in, and, fell down trembling before Paul and Silas, ³⁰ and brought them out and said, 'Sirs, what must I do to be saved?'

Because Paul and Silas stayed:

- The jailer falls down and asks how to be saved.
- He and his whole family hear about Jesus.
- That same night they were **baptized**.

The first miracle Paul and Silas walk in is **self-control**. They stayed, not because they're stuck, but because they see the jailer's life is on the line. Their pain became the door to someone else's **salvation**.



Youth Check-in

“Don’t harm yourself”

The guard fell asleep on duty, and it could have cost him his life! He didn’t want to face his boss and try to explain why the prison was empty (with dried drool on his face)! Paul and Silas’s praise didn’t just free them—it freed everyone in earshot.



Dessert Collective Breakthrough, Acts 16:31–34

³¹ They said, ‘Believe in the Lord Jesus Christ, and you will be saved, you and your household.’ ³² They spoke the word of the Lord to him, and to all who were in his house. ³³ He took them the same hour of the night, and washed their stripes, and was immediately baptized, he and all his household. ³⁴ He brought them up into his house, and set food before them, and rejoiced greatly, with all his household, having believed in God.

Paul and Silas show us:

- You can be in a dark place **and** still choose faith.
- God can turn a prison into a place of praise and a place of salvation.



Reflection Question

Complete this: “God, in my dark moments, help me to choose _____ instead of _____.”



To-Go Box

- No matter what the problem, Jesus will always be the answer.
- Doing the right thing doesn’t always lead to easy places, but God is still there.
- Your worship in hard times is louder than you think—people are listening.
- God can use your midnight to bring someone else into the light.

Write one sentence:

“Lord, help me remember that You are still with me even when I feel _____.”



Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Paul and Silas. When life feels unfair or dark, remind me that You are still worthy of praise. Help me not to give up on You when things hurt. Use my faith in tough times to point other people to You. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Write a short prayer about a “midnight” area in your life where you want to trust God more:

Activity – “Midnight Playlist” (Youth)

Write down:

1. One worship song that helps you trust God when you’re sad or stressed:

2. One verse from this lesson (or another) you can hold onto in a dark time:

3. You can use these as your “**midnight tools**” the next time things feel heavy.

Appendix – Breakfast Month 1 Answer Key

Theme: Prayer, the First Resort



Lesson 1 – Esther: Second Is the Best

1. Vashti
2. Mordecai
3. time
4. Fast

Lesson 2 - Solomon: Wisdom in Response

1. God appeared to **Solomon** in a dream and said, “Ask for what you want Me to give you.”
2. Solomon asked for an **understanding heart** to judge God’s people.
3. God was **pleased** that Solomon asked for wisdom instead of riches or revenge.
4. In Proverbs 2, we are told to seek **wisdom** like silver and hidden treasure.

Lesson 3 - Jesus

Activity – “First Response Check” (Youth)

(Personal responses, for open discussion ...no wrong answers)

Lesson 4 - Paul & Silas

Activity – “Midnight Playlist” (Youth)

(Personal responses, for open discussion ...no wrong answers)

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Break · fast - Month 2

Youth Edition

 **Theme:**

The Art of Through

“The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.”

— Psalm 23:1 (KJV)

Introduction – The Art of Through

“The LORD is my shepherd; I shall not want.” — Psalm 23:1 (KJV)

Ever feel like your life is on a permanent loading screen—like you’re stuck in the lobby while everybody else is leveling up? That’s what a “**through**” season can feel like: you’re trying, you’re praying, you’re doing the right things... but the situation still isn’t moving.



This month is about learning **The Art of Through**. It's not about how to dodge hard seasons, but how to **walk with God in them**—with faith, patience, and courage—until you come out stronger.

This month, we'll learn from four “through” stories:

- **Joseph** — went from pit to prison to purpose, and didn't lose his character.
- **Hannah** — carried deep pain, but turned it into bold prayer and kept showing up.
- **Abram** — trusted God's promise when the timeline didn't make sense.
- **Chronic Conditions** — pushed through obstacles for one touch from Jesus.

Psalm 23 doesn't say you'll never face valleys. It reminds you that the Shepherd is close—so even when you're going through, you don't have to go through it alone.

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY (YE)

Breakfast Edition Month 2: Lesson 1 – Joseph

The Young Dreamer

 **Theme:** The Art of Through

 **Background Text:** Genesis 37; 39; 41–42

 **Key Verse:** Genesis 42:6 (WEB)

“Joseph’s brothers came, and bowed themselves down to him with their faces to the earth.”

Appetizer – The Dream That Started It All Genesis 37:5–8

⁵ Joseph dreamed a dream, and he told it to his brothers, and they hated him all the more. ⁶ He said to them, ‘Please hear this dream which I have dreamed: ⁷ for behold, we were binding sheaves in the field, and behold, my sheaf arose and also stood upright; and behold, your sheaves came around, and bowed down to my sheaf.’

⁸His brothers said to him, ‘Will you indeed reign over us? Or will you indeed have dominion over us?’ They hated him all the more for his dreams and for his words.”

Sometimes when God gives you a big vision, people closest to you might be the first to try and tear it down. The dream was real, but the reaction was rough.

Reflection Question:

Have you ever shared something you were excited about and felt shut down or hated for it?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Betrayed but Chosen, Genesis 37:18–19, 22a, 28

¹⁸ They saw him afar off, and before he came near to them, they conspired against him to kill him. ¹⁹ They said to one another, “Behold, this dreamer comes. ²² Reuben said to them, “Shed no blood. Throw him into this pit that is in the wilderness, but lay no hand on him”

²⁸ Midianites who were merchants passed by, and they drew and lifted up Joseph out of the pit, and sold Joseph to the Ishmaelites for twenty pieces of silver. They brought Joseph into Egypt.

Joseph's own brothers threw him in a pit and sold him. The betrayal by his own blood cut deeper than the dry pit he sat in. Even as he was being hauled off as a slave, God was tracking his location. The "dreamer" was being positioned, even through rejection.

Reflection Question:

What's one "pit moment" in your life—where you felt dropped, betrayed, or abandoned?

Bite 2 – Integrity in the Dark, Gen 39:7–8,17, 20

⁷ After these things, his master's wife set her eyes on Joseph; and she said, 'Lie with me.' ⁸ But he refused, and said... 'How then can I do this great wickedness, and sin against God?' ¹⁷ She spoke to him according to these words, saying, "The Hebrew servant, whom you have brought to us, came in to me to mock me, ²⁰ Joseph's master took him, and put him into the prison, the place where the king's prisoners were bound, and he was there in custody.

Joseph chose purity even when nobody was watching. Doing the right thing led him to prison because of a lie. Joseph teaches us that integrity isn't about getting a quick reward; it's about keeping your character clean so God can trust you with a bigger stage later.

Youth Check-in:

Why is it still worth doing the right thing even when it brings temporary pain instead of a quick reward?

Bite 3 – From Prison to Palace, Gen 41:15-16, 37-39

¹⁵ Pharaoh said to Joseph, "I have dreamed a dream, and there is no one who can interpret it. I have heard it said of you, that when you hear a dream you can interpret it."¹⁶ Joseph answered Pharaoh, saying, 'It isn't in me. God will give Pharaoh an answer of peace.'

³⁷ The thing was good in the eyes of Pharaoh, and in the eyes of all his servants. ³⁸ Pharaoh said to his servants, "Can we find such a one as this, a man in whom is the Spirit of God?" ³⁹ Pharaoh said to Joseph, "Because God has shown you all of this, there is no one so discreet and wise as you.

In one day, God pulled Joseph from the dungeon to the throne room. Joseph walked out ready to serve and gave God all the credit. The years of "through" had prepared his heart to handle the weight of the promotion without losing his soul.

Reflection Question:

If God opened a huge door for you tomorrow, what kind of character would you need to be ready for it?

Dessert-Faith Rewarded, Gen 42:5–6

⁵ The sons of Israel came to buy among those who came, for the famine was in the land of Canaan. ⁶ Joseph was the governor over the land. It was he who sold to all the people of the land. Joseph's brothers came, and bowed themselves down to him with their faces to the earth.

Joseph's story shows:

1. The dream was real, even when reality looked like a nightmare.
2. God never stopped working, even in the silence of the dungeon.
3. What they meant for evil, God worked it out for his good.

Reflection Question:

Right now, does your life feel more like the pit, the prison, or the palace? Why?

To-Go Box

- People can betray you, but God doesn't drop His plans for you.
- Integrity in secret prepares you for influence in public.
- God can use every step to move you toward purpose.

Write one sentence: "God, please use my process to prepare me for my purpose."

Prayer

"Father, thank You for Joseph's story. When I feel stuck or overlooked, remind me that You still see me. Help me stay faithful and honest, even when no one is watching. In Jesus' name, amen."

Personal Prayer Space

Talk to God about one area in your life that feels like a “pit” or a “prison” right now:

Activity -“Pit, Prison, Palace”

Circle which one you relate to most right now and explain why: PIT | PRISON | PALACE

Reason: _____

Notes & Group Discussion

BM2 — Lesson 2: Hannah

Barren but Not Lifeless

 **Theme:** Prayer in the Pain

 **Background Text:** 1 Samuel 1–2

 **Key Verse:** 1 Samuel 1:27 (WEB)

“I prayed for this child, and Yahweh has given me my petition which I asked of him.”

Introduction

Elkanah was a Jewish man with two wives. In that culture, although love was part of why you married, having children was a major factor. Many times, barren women ended up divorced or pushed to the margins of society. Peninnah and Hannah were his wives, but Hannah could not have children.

Have you ever felt like you were “stuck” in someone else’s shadow? Like no matter what you did, the other person always seemed to be one step ahead? That was Hannah’s situation. Year after year, she was humiliated and reminded how much of a “failure” she was as a wife because she could not give Elkanah an heir.

At least her husband loved her, right? It didn’t feel that way. The voice of her tormentor cut deeply, and it seemed as if her prayers were bouncing off the ceiling.

Appetizer – The Weight of Waiting, 1 Sam 1:7–8

“So, year by year, when she went up to Yahweh’s house, her rival provoked her; therefore she wept, and didn’t eat. Elkanah her husband said to her, ‘Hannah, why do you weep? Why don’t you eat? Why is your heart grieved? Am I not better to you than ten sons?’”

Hannah carried a deep ache: she couldn’t have children and was teased for it. Waiting on God can be lonely, especially when it feels like everyone else is getting exactly what you are praying for.

Reflection Question:

When have you felt like someone didn’t understand how deeply something was hurting you?

Main Course

Bite 1 – Provoked but Persistent, 1 Sam 1:9–11

“Hannah rose up after they had eaten... She was in bitterness of soul, and prayed to Yahweh, and wept bitterly. She vowed a vow, and said, ‘Yahweh of Armies, if you will indeed look at the affliction of your servant... and will give to your servant a boy, then I will give him to Yahweh all the days of his life...’”

Hannah brought her pain straight to God. She made a vow that shifted her perspective: she wasn't just asking for a child for herself; she was offering that child back to God. Persistence in prayer is often about moving from "give me" to "let me serve You with it."

Youth Check-in:

Do you know what a vow is? Have you ever made one?

Bite 2 – Misunderstood but Heard, 1 Sam 1:12–16

As she continued praying before Yahweh, Eli observed her mouth. Now Hannah spoke in her heart; only her lips moved, but her voice was not heard. Therefore Eli thought she was drunk. Eli said to her, ‘How long will you be drunk? Get rid of your wine!’ Hannah answered, ‘No, my lord, I am a woman of a sorrowful spirit. I have drunk neither wine nor strong drink, but I poured out my soul before Yahweh.’

Even the priest misjudged her. When you are at your lowest, even "religious" people might misjudge your struggle. But Hannah didn't let a man's mistake stop her from talking to her Maker. God hears the prayers that are too deep for words.

Reflection Question:

What helps you remember that God sees your heart even when others don't?

Bite 3 – Promise Given, Promise Kept, 1 Sam 1:17–18, 20

¹⁶“Don’t consider your servant a wicked woman; for I have been speaking out of the abundance of my complaint and my provocation.” ¹⁷Then Eli answered, “Go in peace; and may the God^[a] of Israel grant your petition that you have asked of him.” ¹⁸She said, “Let your servant find favor in your sight.” So the woman went her way and ate; and her facial expression wasn’t sad any more.

²⁰When the time had come, Hannah conceived, and bore a son; and she named him Samuel,^[a] saying, “Because I have asked him of Yahweh.”

Peace showed up before the answer did. Hannah left her burden at the altar. She didn't have the baby yet, but she had the "yes" in her spirit. Sometimes God changes your heart before He changes your situation to prove He is your source of joy.

 Reflection Question:

Where do you need God's peace while you are still waiting on His answer?

 Dessert -The Song of Victory, 1 Sam 2:1–2

¹Hannah prayed, and said, 'My heart exults in Yahweh! My horn is exalted in Yahweh. My mouth is enlarged over my enemies, because I rejoice in your salvation. ²There is no one as holy as Yahweh, for there is no one besides you, nor is there any rock like our God.'

Hannah's story reminds us that trust in God deepens through the wait. Her song of praise in Chapter 2 shows she found strength not just in her son, but in her Savior.

 Reflection Prompt:

Write one short "line of praise" to God, even if you're still in the middle of your waiting.

 To-Go Box

- God sees the pain you don't know how to explain.
- Honest prayer is better than fake peace.
- God can give you peace in your heart before the answer shows up in your hands.

 Prayer

"Lord, thank You for seeing Hannah's tears. Give me peace while I wait, and help me trust that You haven't forgotten me. In Jesus' name, amen."

Activity – “Hannah’s Hope Steps” (YE)

1. Circle One Word for Each Step:

- **Her pain:** (ignored / mocked / empty / confused)
- **Her response:** (shut down / prayed / fought back / ran away)
- **God’s move:** (forgot her / heard her / punished her / blessed her)

Multiple Choice /Fill in the Blank

1. Elkanah was married to _____.
a. Hannah and Peninnah
b. Hannah and Phinehas
c. Hophni and Peninnah
d. None of the above
Answer.
2. Elkanah and his wives would go to sacrifice in _____ at the Lord of _____.
a. Judah, Heaven’s Armies
b. Judah, Heaven’s Angries
c. Shiloh, Heaven’s Armies
d. Shiloh, Heaven’s Angries
Answer.
3. A vow is a _____.
4. Hannah promised to never _____.
(a) Fight Peninnah
(b) Cut her child’s hair
(c) Lie again
(d) Come to the temple drunk
Answer.
5. “Seeing her lips _____ but hearing no _____, he thought she had been _____.”

Notes Section & Group Discussion

BM2: Lesson 3 – Abram

No Heir, Wait Here

 **Theme:** Trusting God when the wait is long

 **Background Text:** Genesis 15:1–6; 16:1–5; 17:1–8

 **Key Verse:** Genesis 15:6 (WEB)

“He believed in Yahweh, who credited it to him for righteousness.”

Appetizer – Honest Questions Genesis 15:1–3

¹ After these things Yahweh’s word came to Abram in a vision, saying, ‘Don’t be afraid, Abram. I am your shield, your exceedingly great reward.’ ² Abram said, ‘Lord Yahweh, what will you give me, since I go childless, and he who will inherit my estate is Eliezer of Damascus?’ ³ Abram said, ‘Behold, to me you have given no children; and, behold, one born in my house is my heir.’

Abram was blunt: “God, what does it matter if I’m still childless?” It’s okay to ask God “how” and “when.” Faith isn’t pretending you aren’t confused; faith is bringing your confusion to the One who has the answers.

Main Course

Bite 1 – Count the Stars, Gen 15:4–6

⁴ Behold, Yahweh’s word came to him, saying, ‘This man will not be your heir, but he who will come out of your own body will be your heir.’ ⁵ Yahweh brought him outside, and said, ‘Look now toward the sky, and count the stars, if you are able to count them.’ He said to Abram, ‘So shall your offspring be.’ ⁶ He believed in Yahweh, who credited it to him for righteousness.

God gave Abram a visual aid—stars in the sky. He told Abram that his legacy would be just as vast and impossible to count. Abram chose to believe God’s word over his own biology. When your reality looks empty, look up at what God has already spoken over your life.

Reflection Question:

What are some “stars” (Scriptures) God has used to encourage you during a wait?

Bite 2 – When We Try to “Help” God, Gen 16:1–4

¹ Now Sarai, Abram’s wife, bore him no children. She had a servant, an Egyptian, whose name was Hagar. ² Sarai said to Abram, ‘See now, Yahweh has restrained me from bearing. Please go in to my servant. It may be that I will obtain children by her.’ Abram listened to the voice of Sarai.

³ After Abram had lived ten years in the land of Canaan, Sarai took Hagar the Egyptian, her servant, and gave her to Abram her husband to be his wife. ⁴ He went to Hagar, and she conceived. When she saw that she had conceived, her mistress was despised in her eyes.

Abram and Sarai tried to "force" the promise through Hagar. This "shortcut" created a mess that lasted for generations. We often create more "through" for ourselves when we try to take the wheel away from God. God doesn't need your help; He needs your trust.

Reflection Question:

Where are you tempted to rush into your own plan because God seems slow?

Bite 3 – Name Changed, Same Promise, Gen 17:1–5, 7

¹ When Abram was ninety-nine years old, Yahweh appeared to Abram and said to him, ‘I am God Almighty. Walk before me, and be blameless. ² I will make my covenant between me and you, and will multiply you exceedingly.’ ³ Abram fell on his face. God talked with him, saying, ⁴ ‘As for me, behold, my covenant is with you. You will be the father of a multitude of nations.

⁵ Your name will no longer be called Abram, but your name will be Abraham; for I have made you the father of a multitude of nations. ⁷ I will establish my covenant between me and you and your offspring after you throughout their generations for an everlasting covenant...’

Years later, God changed Abram’s name to Abraham ("Father of many"). God was calling him what he *would* be before he *saw* it. Your identity is fixed by God’s promise, not your current progress.

Reflection Question:

How does it help to remember what God calls you when your situation doesn’t look like it?

Dessert – Faith Rewarded Through Time, Romans 4:20–21

²⁰ Yet, looking to the promise of God, he didn’t waver through unbelief, but grew strong through faith, giving glory to God, ²¹ and being fully assured that what he had promised, he was also able to perform.

Abraham's story says:

1. Real faith is honest enough to ask hard questions.
2. Real faith can still stumble, but God picks it back up.
3. God's timing is perfect, even when it feels "late."

Reflection Question:

What is there an area where you need to stop forcing outcomes and start trusting God again?

To-Go Box

- God isn't scared of your honest questions.
- Shortcuts can complicate your life even when God still loves you.
- God's promises stand, even when your patience doesn't.

Write one sentence: "God, help me trust You with _____."

Prayer

"God Almighty, forgive me for the times I've tried to rush Your plan. Help me to walk before You with a trusting heart. In Jesus' name, amen."

Personal Prayer Space

Write about one area where you want to slow down and trust God's timing:

Activity – "True or False"

1. Abraham never questioned God. (T / F)
2. Sarai suggested using Hagar. (T / F)
3. God changed Abram's name. (T / F)

† BM2 — Lesson 4: Chronic Conditions

💧 Victory Through the Blood

📘 **Theme:** From “unclean” to whole

📖 **Background Text:** Luke 8:42–48

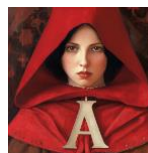
🔑 **Key Verse:** Luke 8:48 (WEB)

He said to her, ‘**Daughter, cheer up. Your faith has made you well. Go in peace.**’

✨ **Author’s Foreword (Intro/Reflection Setup)**

“Unclean, Unclean, Unclean!”

In the Jewish law, as depicted in the Pentateuch, many illnesses and conditions could make a person “unclean.” Those labeled unclean could not enter the temple, attend gatherings, or move freely in the community. Some were restricted to their homes or pushed outside normal society. They had to *announce* their condition whenever they came near people.



make

Imagine living in a world where you had to brandish your “dirty secret” like the old Scarlet Letter—exposed, ashamed, and isolated.

Now imagine carrying that weight not for a few days, but for **twelve years**.

📖 **Appetizer – Twelve Years of Pain, Luke 8:42b–43a**

“...But as he went, the multitudes pressed against him. ⁴³ A woman who had a flow of blood for twelve years...”

For twelve years, this woman lived as an outcast. She was broke and broken. She was stuck in the “through.” Sometimes the hardest part isn’t the pain, it’s the feeling that society has forgotten you.

You’ve tried every YouTube remedy, every social media hack, every doctor, every urgent care, every “miracle” treatment and payment plan... and still no solution. Your resources are drained, and the situation hasn’t changed. That was the woman’s reality.

Imagine having a condition that silently drains you from the inside for over a decade. No clear answers. No lasting relief. Just ongoing pain, shame, and exhaustion.

💬 **Reflection Question:**

What kind of problem today might make someone feel like they're "unclean"?

Main Course – Faith That Reaches Out

Bite 1 – A Desperate Touch, Luke 8:43b–44

“...who had spent all her living on physicians and could not be healed by any, came behind him and touched the fringe of his cloak. Immediately the flow of her blood stopped.”

If you've ever been to a concert of a popular person, you know how thick the crowd is to just get close to the stage. ...She didn't ask for the microphone, or a front-row seat, or a special audience. She just wanted to get close enough to **touch** Jesus—close enough to reach for the One everyone else was only crowding around.

Well, Jesus was on his way to heal a sick child, when she reached for the hem in a "risk-it-all" move. She wasn't even supposed to be there.

Faith is often a desperate reach toward Jesus when you have nothing left to lose. Her faith pulled power directly from the Source, and that was the difference between the people who were there just to be there and a woman you refused to be denied wholeness (or a cure).

Reflection Question:

What does it look like for you to “reach for Jesus” today?

Bite 2 – “Who Touched Me?” Luke 8:45–47

⁴⁵ Jesus said, ‘Who touched me?’ When all denied it, Peter and those with him said, ‘Master, the multitudes press and jostle you, and you say, ‘Who touched me?’ ’ ⁴⁶ But Jesus said, ‘Someone did touch me, for I perceived that power has gone out of me.’ ⁴⁷ When the woman saw that she was not hidden, she came trembling, and falling down before him declared to him in the presence of all the people the reason why she had touched him, and how she was healed immediately.”

Jesus stopped everything to find her. He wasn't mad; He wanted her to be known. He didn't just heal her body; He healed her shame by letting her tell her story out loud. God doesn't want you to slip away; He wants to give you a public testimony. Your wholeness matters.

Reflection Question:

Why did Jesus want her to speak up instead of slipping away?

Bite 3 – New Name, New Peace, Luke 8:48

⁴⁸ He said to her, ‘Daughter, cheer up. Your faith has made you well. Go in peace.’

Jesus called her *Daughter*. In one word, she went from a social outcast to part of the family of God. Her faith didn't just stop the bleeding; it started a new life. Jesus always gives you more than what you originally came for. He provided not only what she wanted (which was to be cured), but what she needed, that is wholeness.

Author's Commentary

Her long struggle ended with a single word of affirmation from Jesus. When He calls you Daughter or Son, He doesn't just fix your issue—He restores your place in the family. The Woman with the Issue of Blood is a story that many can relate to you having a problem and unfortunately making God or prayer your “last resort”, it's like the dreaded red button under the glass that you do NOT want to push! Push - Pray Until Something Happens - let your faith connect with the Word and power of God. Nobody is saying don't go to the doctor, but the message is about bringing your faith to the doctor's office and bring your ISSUES to the altar.

So many of us have suffered in things for a long while, and Jesus is waiting on us to do our part and trust him with it. Break through the doubt, press through the challenges and arrive at the hem of God and the spiritual connection to the healing that was released when our Savior was tied and hung on a tree. Through an long term unclean messed up, messy situation - though her blood was filthy his Blood is cleansing and through it there is victory to everyone who is willing to accept all the benefits of being redeemed, hallelujah!

Dessert

Her condition made her “unclean” to people, but her faith made her a focus for God. Jesus' blood is the only thing that can truly wash away the labels life has stuck on you.

Reflection Question:

Finish this: “Jesus, I want to trade the label _____ for what

You say: _____.”

To-Go Box

- No one is too broken for Jesus.
- Faith doesn't have to be loud; it can be a quiet reach.
- Jesus restores identity, not just health.

Write one sentence: "Jesus, thank You that You call me _____."

Prayer

"Jesus, thank You for seeing me. Replace every negative label I've carried with Your love. In Your name, amen."

Activity – "Crossword Clues"

1. The problem lasted _____ years.
2. Jesus said, "Your _____ has made you well."
3. The woman touched the _____ of His cloak.
4. Jesus called her _____.

Notes & Group Discussion

Appendix – Breakfast Month 2 (YE) Answer Key

Theme: The Art of Through – Youth Edition

Lesson 1 – Joseph: The Young Dreamer

Activity – “Pit, Prison, Palace”

This activity is reflective, so responses will vary. Use student answers to gauge where they feel they are and how they plan to stay faithful.

Typical mappings you can look for:

- PIT – “I feel dropped/ignored.”
Connected to rejection, betrayal, or feeling thrown aside (like Joseph in the pit and being sold).
- PRISON – “I feel stuck/limited.”
Connected to feeling trapped, delayed, or held back (like Joseph in prison).
- PALACE – “I see God’s favor opening doors.”
Connected to seasons of opportunity and visible favor (like Joseph ruling in Egypt).

For their written response, look for:

- A clear description of which stage they relate to now, and
- At least one concrete way they can stay faithful to God in that place (prayer, integrity, obedience, serving, wise choices, etc.).

Lesson 2 – Hannah: Barren but Not Lifeless

Activity – “Hannah’s Hope Steps”

Part 1 – Circle One Word for Each Step

Her pain: ✓ Most fitting choices: mocked/ empty
(She is provoked, reminded of her barrenness, and deeply grieved.)

Her response: ✓ prayed

God’s move: Most fitting choices: ✓ heard her and blessed her
(He hears her prayer and later gives her Samuel.)

Part 2 – Short Response

Answers will differ. Healthy responses often mention:

- Bringing pain honestly to God,
 - Trusting that God sees and remembers,
 - Being encouraged to keep praying and hoping even while waiting.
-

Lesson 3 – Abram: No Heir, Wait Here

Activity – “True or False: Trust the Timeline”

1. “Abraham never questioned or struggled with God’s promises.” ➤ False
(He questioned God about being childless and agreed to Sarai’s plan with Hagar.)
 2. “Sarai suggested using Hagar to get a child.” ➤ True
 3. “God changed Abram’s name after reaffirming His covenant.” ➤ True
(Name changed to Abraham in Genesis 17.)
 4. “God’s timing often tests our faith before we see the promise.” ➤ True
-

Lesson 4 – Victory Through the Blood

Activity – “Crossword Clues (Fill-in Version)”

1. The woman had a problem with her _____ for twelve years. ➤ blood
2. Jesus said, “Your _____ has made you well.” ➤ faith
3. The woman touched the _____ of Jesus’ cloak. ➤ hem/fringe
(You can also accept fringe if it appears in your wording.)
4. Jesus called her _____, not “unclean.” ➤ Daughter

Soul Food Break*fast



Created By: Dr. D Brown



Snack Pack | Month 3

Foundation in Christ | Youth Edition

SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES

Break · fast - Month 3

Youth Edition

 Theme:

Faith & Foresight

“⁶ In nothing be anxious, but in everything, by prayer and petition with thanksgiving, let your requests be made known to God. ”

— Phil4:6 (WEB)

Table of Contents

.....	1
SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY SERIES.....	2
Faith & Foresight	2
Table of Contents.....	3
Introduction – Faith & Foresight.....	5
 Breakfast Edition Month 3 - Lesson 1: Rahab.....	6
Faith That Took Action	6
 Appetizer – The Risk That Changed Her Life, Josh, 2:1, 3–4	6
 Main Course.....	7
 Bite 1 – The Risk That Redefined a Life, Josh 2:8-11a.....	7
 Bite 2 – When Faith Meets Action, Josh 2:12–14, 17-18.....	7
 Bite 3 – Faith That Rewrites the Future, Josh 6:22–23, 25 (<i>paraphrased</i>).....	8
 Dessert – Faith That Didn’t Wait, Heb 11:31	9
 Activity – True or False: Rahab’s Faith.....	9
 BM3 — Lesson 2: Abigail.....	10
Wisdom on the Move.....	10
 Appetizer – The Courage to Step In, 1 Sam 25:18–20.....	10
 Main Course.....	10
 Bite 1 – The Foolishness of Nabal, 1 Sam 25:10–11, 14, 17	10
 Bite 2 – Put the Blame on Me, 1 Sam 25:23-24, 28.....	11
 Bite 3 – A Wise Outcome, 1 Sam 25:32–33, 35	12
 Dessert – When God Handles It, 1 Sam 25:38–39	12
 Activity – Fill in the Blank	13
 BM3 — Lesson 3: The Centurion.....	14
Faith That Commands Results	14
 Appetizer – The Power of the Word, Matt 8:5–8.....	14
 Main Course	14
 Bite 1 – Faith That Understands Authority, Matt 8:8–9a	14
 Bite 2 – Faith That Amazed Jesus, Matt 8:10, 13.....	15
 Author’s Commentary	15
 Bite 3 –The Sent Word, John 1:1,14.....	16
 Author’s Commentary	16
 Dessert – Beyond a Resume - A Word Is Enough	16
 Activity – Fill in the Blank	17
 BM3 — Lesson 4: Joseph of Arimathea.....	18
Trust the Process.....	18
 Appetizer – Faith in Action, John 19:38a; Matt 27:57–58	18

 Main Course	18
 Bite 1 – Prepared Before He Knew Why, Matt 27:57–60	18
 Bite 2 – Courage to Be Counted, John 19:38–39	19
 Bite 3 – Faith Sealed in Stone, John 19:40–42	19
📖 Author’s Commentary	19
🍰 Dessert – Trusting What You Can’t See Yet	20
🎯 Activity – Connect the Process	21
Appendix – Breakfast Month 3 (YE) Answer Key	22
👉 Lesson 1 – Rahab: Faith That Took Action.....	22
👉 Lesson 2 – Abigail: Wisdom on the Move.....	22
👉 Lesson 3 – The Centurion: Faith That Commands Results.....	22
👉 Lesson 4 – Joseph of Arimathea: Trust the Process	23
CREDITS & ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS	24
Back Cover: Why Soul Food? By Dr. D. Brown	26

Introduction – Faith & Foresight

“Now faith is the substance of things hoped for, the evidence of things not seen.” — Hebrews 11:1 (KJV)

Ever feel like your life is glitching because you can't see the next level? Faith and foresight are like having a 5G connection to God's plan and a GPS that sees around the corners you haven't turned yet. Faith is believing in what you can't see yet, while foresight is the spiritual "prep work" for the promises



God has already signed off on. Together, they keep you making boss moves today because you trust God's win for your tomorrow.

This month, we'll walk with four people who mastered Faith & Foresight:

- **Rahab** – Had the foresight to align with God's people before the walls ever came down.
- **Abigail** – Used foresight to intercept a disaster and stop a war before it started.
- **The Centurion** – Operated in a level of faith that saw healing from a distance.
- **Joseph of Arimathea** – Prepared for the King by having a tomb ready before the cross.

In this study, we're going to discover that walking with God isn't just about "vibes"—it's about having vision. Faith hears God's voice, and foresight prepares the plan.



SOUL FOOD BIBLE STUDY (AE)



Breakfast Edition Month 3 - Lesson 1: Rahab

Faith That Took Action



Theme: Faith & Foresight



Background Text: Joshua 2:1–21; 6:22–25



Key Verse: Hebrews 11:31 (WEB)

“By faith, Rahab the prostitute didn’t perish with those who were disobedient, having received the spies in peace.”



Faith that acts before the promise is visible.



Appetizer – The Risk That Changed Her Life, Josh, 2:1, 3–4

Joshua the son of Nun secretly sent two men out of Shittim as spies, saying, “Go, view the land, including Jericho.” They went and came into the house of a prostitute whose name was Rahab, and slept there.

³ Jericho’s king sent to Rahab, saying, “Bring out the men who have come to you, who have entered into your house; for they have come to spy out all the land. ⁴ The woman took the two men and hid them. Then she said, “Yes, the men came to me, but I didn’t know where they came from.

Rahab had to choose: stay safe with the crowd, or step out in risky obedience toward God. Her decision wasn’t just about her; it affected her whole family. She did not know the God of the Israelites but she knew of what he had done in and for His people and that was enough for her to regard them higher than her culture and her king.



Reflection Question:

Have you ever known the right thing to do but felt scared to actually do it? What held you back—or what helped you move anyway?

Main Course

Bite 1 – The Risk That Redefined a Life, Josh 2:8-11a

⁸ Before they had lain down, she came up to them on the roof. ⁹ She said to the men, “I know that Yahweh has given you the land, and that the fear of you has fallen upon us, and that all the inhabitants of the land melt away before you.

¹⁰ For we have heard how Yahweh dried up the water of the Red Sea before you, when you came out of Egypt; and what you did to the two kings of the Amorites, who were beyond the Jordan, to Sihon and to Og, whom you utterly destroyed. ¹¹ As soon as we had heard it, our hearts melted, and there wasn’t any more spirit in any man, because of you: for Yahweh your God, he is God.

Faith comes by *hearing*—and Rahab proves it. She believed without ever seeing the Red Sea part or the Amorite kings fall. Testimonies of God’s power traveled farther than Israel’s feet, and those stories were enough to birth faith in her heart.

Rahab wasn’t an Israelite. She didn’t grow up in church or know all the laws. But she heard what God had done—and believed it. While others hardened their hearts, she let fear turn into faith. Faith often starts with hearing what God has done—through Scripture, testimonies, or your own past moments with Him.

Reflection Question:

What’s one story (from the Bible or real life) that has strengthened your faith in God?

Bite 2 – When Faith Meets Action, Josh 2:12–14, 17-18

¹² Now therefore, please swear to me by Yahweh, since I have dealt kindly with you, that you also will deal kindly with my father’s house, and give me a true sign; ¹³ and that you will save alive my father, my mother, my brothers, and my sisters, and all that they have, and will deliver our lives from death.”

¹⁴ The men said to her, “Our life for yours, if you don’t talk about this business of ours; and it shall be, when Yahweh gives us the land, that we will deal kindly and truly with you.”

¹⁷ The men said to her, “We will be guiltless of this your oath which you’ve made us to swear. ¹⁸ Behold, when we come into the land, tie this line of scarlet thread in the window which you used to let us down. Gather to yourself into the house your father, your mother, your brothers, and all your father’s household.

Rahab’s temptation was the King and his men, her culture -instead of going with what she knew, she went with what was right. It wasn’t the popular choice, but it was a life changing one! Rahab didn’t just believe; she made a covenant. The scarlet rope became a sign: when judgment came, her house would be marked by faith and spared.

Her faith wasn’t passive; it was tied to **obedience**.

Author's Testimony

Rahab's scarlet rope wasn't magic; it was her decision to trust God over her surroundings. Standing your ground takes boldness. You might feel scared, and that's fine—move anyway! I remember in school when everyone planned to ditch class for a party. The pressure to follow the crowd was heavy, but I heard a 'voice' say, 'Don't go.' That was God. We must spot those spiritual lifelines so we can stay safe, even when everyone else is heading the wrong way.

Reflection Question:

What is one “scarlet rope” in your life—a visible step of obedience that shows you're trusting God?

Bite 3 – Faith That Rewrites the Future, Josh 6:22–23, 25 (*paraphrased*)

²²Joshua said... “Go into the prostitute’s house, and bring out from there the woman, and all that she has, as you swore to her.” ²⁴So the young men... brought out Rahab, her father, her mother, her brothers, and all that she had... ²⁵ Joshua saved Rahab... and she lives in the middle of Israel to this day...

Rahab's faith saved her whole household. While we could be tempted to ‘park it right there’ ...on the fact that she made sure her whole family benefited and avoided selfish acts...her story doesn't stop but transitions from there! Later, she would be included in the family line that led to Jesus. Not bad for someone everyone else would have written off.

God can take a life marked by shame and rewrite it with purpose. Faith doesn't erase your past—but it invites God to redeem it. Lifelines aren't for a moment, it can be the shift, the break the new path you never knew you needed. Rahab didn't look back at the rumble, at her old life at any leverage she built from what she did in the past, she left it where it belonged in her-story. Your past doesn't define you. Nor your present confine you, allow God to refine you and show you what life is like in Him.

Reflection Question:

Who might be saved, inspired, or transformed by **your** act of faith today?

Dessert – Faith That Didn’t Wait, Heb 11:31

“By faith, Rahab the prostitute didn’t perish with those who were disobedient, having received the spies in peace.”

Rahab could’ve waited until things were safer, clearer, or more convenient-but procrastination had one problem-there was no guarantee. Instead, she moved when God gave her the chance. There is no perfect or “good” or “ideal” time to accept salvation, the best time is NOW.

God didn’t highlight Rahab’s past to shame her but to magnify His grace. Her label didn’t stop her legacy. Faith rewrote her ending—and it can rewrite yours too.

Youth Check-in

Finish this sentence: “God, I don’t want to wait until it’s safe to obey You. Help me to _____.”



To-Go Box

- Faith can start in unexpected places and people.
 - Hearing what God has done can lead you to trust what He’s doing now.
 - Your history does not disqualify you; your response to God’s invitation defines you.
-



Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Rahab’s courage and for showing me that You can use anyone who trusts You. Help me listen when You speak, obey even when it feels risky, and believe that You can rewrite my story and my family’s story. In Jesus’ name, amen.”



Personal Prayer Space

Write a short prayer asking God to grow your courage and faith like Rahab’s:



Activity – True or False: Rahab’s Faith

Read each statement and circle T for True or F for False.

1. Rahab was an Israelite woman raised in a godly home. T / F
2. The scarlet rope was a sign of the agreement between Rahab and the spies. T / F
3. Rahab’s actions showed both faith in God and concern for her family. T / F
4. Rahab’s faith only affected her, not anyone else. T / F
5. Rahab is later mentioned in the family line of Jesus. T / F

BM3 — Lesson 2: Abigail

Wisdom on the Move



Theme: Faith & Foresight



Background Text: 1 Samuel 25:2–35



Key Verse: Proverbs 15:1 (WEB)

“A gentle answer turns away wrath, but a harsh word stirs up anger.”



Wisdom in motion: faith that chooses peace over pride.



Appetizer – The Courage to Step In, 1 Sam 25:18–20

¹⁸ Then Abigail hurried and took two hundred loaves of bread, two containers of wine, five sheep ready dressed, five seahs^[a] of parched grain, one hundred clusters of raisins, and two hundred cakes of figs, and laid them on donkeys. ¹⁹ She said to her young men, “Go on before me. Behold, I am coming after you.” But she didn’t tell her husband, Nabal. ²⁰ As she rode on her donkey, and came down hidden by the mountain, behold, David and his men came down toward her, and she met them.

David was angry because Nabal had insulted him and refused to help. Recognizing how foul her husband behaved, Abigail stepped in quickly to bring food, humility, and peace before things got violent. Abigail didn’t wait for someone else to fix it. She saw danger coming and moved with wisdom and courage, this is called intercession or prevention or de-escalation.

Abigail didn’t wait for permission to do what was right. She used foresight—seeing danger ahead and acting to prevent disaster. Her faith wasn’t just belief; it was movement toward peace.



Reflection Question:

Have you ever seen drama or conflict building and wished someone would step in with wisdom? What did you do?



Main Course



Bite 1 – The Foolishness of Nabal, 1 Sam 25:10–11, 14, 17

¹⁰ Nabal answered David’s servants and said, “Who is David? Who is the son of Jesse? There are many servants who break away from their masters these days. ¹¹ Shall I then take my bread, my water, and my meat that I have killed for my shearers, and give it to men who I don’t know where they come from?”

¹⁴ But one of the young men told Abigail, Nabal’s wife, saying, “Behold, David sent messengers out of the wilderness to greet our master; and he insulted them. ¹⁷ Now therefore know and

consider what you will do; for evil is determined against our master and against all his house, for he is such a worthless fellow that one can't speak to him."

Nabal's arrogance created a dangerous situation. His pride didn't just affect him—it put his whole household at risk. Nabal's servants quickly pulled up the 'receipts,' recalling exactly how David and his men had been a wall of protection for them and the flock. Even with the facts on the table, Nabal's ego was too loud for him to recognize David's kindness or judge the moment correctly.

His arrogance—that 'better than everyone else' attitude—blinded him to the fact that doing right by David's men wasn't just a suggestion; it was a requirement. It's a powerful lesson for us: someone else's foolishness can trigger a storm you didn't ask for, but even then, you can still choose wisdom and change the forecast.

Reflection Question:

When have you seen someone's pride or anger make things worse for everyone around them?

Bite 2 – Put the Blame on Me, 1 Sam 25:23-24, 28

²³ When Abigail saw David, she hurried and got off her donkey, and fell before David on her face and bowed herself to the ground. ²⁴ She fell at his feet and said, "On me, my lord, on me be the blame! Please let your servant speak in your ears. Hear the words of your servant.

²⁸ Please forgive the trespass of your servant. For Yahweh will certainly make my lord a sure house, because my lord fights Yahweh's battles. Evil will not be found in you all your days.

Abigail took responsibility for something she didn't do, in order to save lives. She reminded David of his calling and helped him think about his future reputation.

"Standing in the gap isn't about being a doormat; it's about being a shock absorber. It means you care more about God's honor and keeping people safe than about winning a petty argument. An 'Abigail move' can literally save a life—I know because it happened to me.

Author's Testimony

In high school, I had a gun pulled on me just for telling a story that 'triggered' someone. Another teen stepped in—she didn't have to get involved, but she saw the 'glitch' before it crashed everyone's future.

She moved fast, talked him down, and convinced him to put it away. I had to report it, but if it wasn't for my Abigail intercepting that disaster, I wouldn't be here to tell the story. Sometimes God calls you to absorb the tension so the situation doesn't explode."

Reflection Questions:

What does it mean to “stand in the gap” for someone? When is it wise to step in—and when might it be unsafe?

Bite 3 – A Wise Outcome, 1 Sam 25:32–33, 35

³² David said to Abigail, “Blessed is Yahweh, the God of Israel, who sent you today to meet me! ³³ Blessed is your discretion, and blessed are you, who have kept me today from blood guiltiness, and from avenging myself with my own hand.

³⁵ So David received from her hand that which she had brought him. Then he said to her, “Go up in peace to your house. Behold, I have listened to your voice and have granted your request.”

David calmed down. The fight stopped before it ever started. Abigail’s actions saved her household and kept David from making a choice he’d regret. Hallelujah, praise the Lord he listened to reason.

One wise, humble conversation can stop a lot of damage.

Reflection Question:

Think of a time when you calmed a situation down—or wish you had. What would wisdom look like next time?

Dessert – When God Handles It, 1 Sam 25:38–39

³⁸ About ten days later, Yahweh struck Nabal, so that he died. ³⁹ When David heard that Nabal was dead, he said, “Blessed is Yahweh, who has pleaded the cause of my reproach from the hand of Nabal, and has kept back his servant from evil. Yahweh has returned the evildoing of Nabal on his own head.”

God handled Nabal in His own time. Abigail’s job wasn’t revenge—it was obedience and wisdom. David had to exercise restraint and to recognize and listen to the wisdom. God did the rest, hallelujah and amen.

Reflection Prompt:

Write one sentence asking God to help you choose wisdom instead of revenge.

To-Go Box

- Pride creates problems; wisdom creates peace.
- Sometimes God uses you to de-escalate what someone else started.
- Let God handle judgment; your role is to respond with wisdom and courage.

Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Abigail’s example of courage and wisdom. Help me not to react out of pride or anger. Show me when to speak up, when to step in, and when to step back and let You handle it. Give me a gentle answer and a wise heart. In Jesus’ name, amen.”

Personal Prayer Space

Write a short prayer asking God to help you respond with wisdom in conflict:

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with _____ and faith, not fear.
2. Nabal’s pride led to his _____.
3. David praised God for Abigail’s _____.
4. Abigail’s wisdom prevented _____ and brought peace.

Notes Section— Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM3 — Lesson 3: The Centurion

Faith That Commands Results



Theme: Trusting Jesus' Word



Background Text: Matthew 8:5–13; Luke 7:1–10



Key Verse: Matthew 8:10 (WEB)

When Jesus heard it, he marveled, and said... ‘Most certainly I tell you, I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel.’



Faith that trusts the Word, not the circumstances.



Appetizer – The Power of the Word, Matt 8:5–8

⁵ When he came into Capernaum, a centurion came to him, asking him for help, ⁶ saying, “Lord, my servant lies in the house paralyzed, grievously tormented.” ⁷ Jesus said to him, “**I will come and heal him.**” The centurion answered, ‘Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed.’

The centurion didn’t ask Jesus for a visit—he asked Him for a word. He believed that one word from Jesus could travel farther and work faster than any doctor, medicine, or ritual.

The centurion refused to overlook his servant’s need but rather recognized that compassion and action were needed for relief. Faith sometimes starts with one simple cry: “Lord, I need You.”



Reflection Question:

If you could ask Jesus for help in one situation right now, what would it be?



Main Course



Bite 1 – Faith That Understands Authority, Matt 8:8–9a

The centurion answered, “Lord, I’m not worthy for you to come under my roof. Just say the word, and my servant will be healed. For I also am a man under authority, having under myself soldiers. I tell this one, ‘Go,’ and he goes...”

He didn’t need Jesus to walk to his house. He understood that if Jesus had authority, then His word was enough—even from a distance. Real faith doesn’t always need a physical sign. It trusts that when Jesus speaks, it’s already done.

 Reflection Question:

Do you sometimes feel like you need to “feel something” for your prayers to work? What would it look like to trust God’s Word even when you don’t feel anything?

 Bite 2 – Faith That Amazed Jesus, Matt 8:10, 13

When Jesus heard it, he marveled... “I haven’t found so great a faith, not even in Israel.” ... Jesus said to the centurion, “Go your way. As you have believed, so be it done for you.” His servant was healed in that hour.

Jesus was amazed at this man’s faith. Not because he was perfect or religious, but because he believed Jesus’ word completely. Your background doesn’t limit your faith.

 Author’s Commentary

Jesus is moved by trust, not titles. Aligning with the Great "I AM" starts with your words. Think about it: in the very first chapter of the Bible, the Creator didn’t use hands or tools to build the universe—He spoke ten times, and reality shifted.

Proverbs 18:21 tells us that life and death are held in the power of the tongue, and Isaiah 55:11 explains the authority behind that release. The Centurion understood the assignment. He knew that while "laying on of hands" might make people feel better, the real work happens when a word is released. He didn't need a ritual; he just needed a command. That word ricochets through eternity until it hits the target.

In the modern world, we say "Say Less"—because when you are walking in strong faith, you don’t need a long speech. That level of trust was the "IT" factor that turned his request into a power move.

 Youth Check-In (YES/NO):

Do you believe that Jesus can move in situations you can’t physically control?

☐ YES ☐ NO  **Reflection Question:**

Where do you need to trust Jesus at a distance—where you can’t personally fix it?

Bite 3 –The Sent Word, John 1:1,14

1 In the beginning was the Word, and the Word was with God, and the Word was God. ¹⁴ And the Word was made flesh, and dwelt among us, (and we beheld his glory, the glory as of the only begotten of the Father,) full of grace and truth.

The centurion had many reasons why he didn't believe Jesus needed to physically come, but Emmanuel, was happy someone caught the revelation. When he sent the word, he sent HIMSELF, because he was and is the Word! Whew...

Author's Commentary

Being a high-ranking commander in the Roman Empire didn't make the Centurion a villain—it gave him a platform. Instead of using his power to hurt people, he leveraged it to help them. That's why others were so quick to vouch for his character and tell Jesus why he deserved a hand.'

But here's the real power move: despite his status, he was completely humble. He didn't think his "good guy" resume or his high-level titles made him worthy of having God in the flesh walk through his front door. It was as if he said, "With all my accolades, I'm still not worthy—but I'm asking anyway. If You just say the word, that's all I need." **Faith isn't just about your miracle; it's also about how God wants to use you to stand in the gap for others.**

Reflection Question:

Who could you be praying for or believing for, like the centurion did for his servant?

Dessert – Beyond a Resume - A Word Is Enough

Jesus didn't respond to the wealth, the power, or the "good guy" resume. He responded to a heart in need. When we say "Amen," we are literally saying **"It is so."** It's the moment we stop looking for a physical sign and come into total agreement with what God has already spoken. The Centurion didn't need a visit; he just needed a Word. He knew that once the Word was released, the shift was already final.

Youth Check-in:

Write a one-sentence declaration of faith that starts with:

"Jesus, Your word is enough for _____."

To-Go Box

- Faith trusts Jesus' authority even at a distance.
 - Jesus is moved by trust, not by status or background.
 - You can use your faith to intercede for others, not just yourself.
-

Prayer

"Jesus, thank You for showing me the centurion's example. Help me trust Your word even when I don't see or feel immediate change. Grow my faith so that it not only covers my life, but also the lives of people I care about. In Your name, amen."

Personal Prayer Space

Write a prayer for someone else who needs Jesus' help, like the centurion's servant did:

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion's faith worked even at a _____.
 2. Jesus said, "I have not found anyone in Israel with such great _____."
 3. True faith doesn't need evidence; it trusts the _____.
 4. The centurion understood the power of _____.
-

Notes Section — Group Discussion & Personal Study

BM3 — Lesson 4: Joseph of Arimathea

Trust the Process



Theme: Faith & Foresight



Background Text: Matthew 27:57–61; John 19:38–42



Key Verse: John 19:38 (WEB)

After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus' body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body.

 *Faith that honors Jesus even when the story looks finished.*

Appetizer – Faith in Action, John 19:38a; Matt 27:57–58

³⁸ After these things, Joseph of Arimathaea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews,

⁵⁷ When the even was come, there came a rich man of Arimathaea, named Joseph, who also himself was Jesus' disciple: ⁵⁸ He went to Pilate, and begged the body of Jesus. Then Pilate commanded the body to be delivered

Jesus had a massive following beyond the famous twelve, including a 70-person "prep team" (Luke 10:1) that cleared the path for His ministry. Within that broader group was Joseph of Arimathea. He wasn't in the immediate inner-circle or the loudest voice in the room; he was a high-influence leader following Jesus on "quiet mode."

But real faith isn't about being the loudest—it's about being there when it counts. When his inner-circle disciples scattered after the crucifixion, Joseph stepped out of the shadows. He used his clout and resources to handle the King's business when many others hid in grief and fear, proving you don't need a "main stage" title to be the one God uses to capture the moment.

Reflection Question:

Have you ever done the right thing quietly, even if nobody noticed?



Main Course



Bite 1 – Prepared Before He Knew Why, Matt 27:57–60

⁵⁹ Joseph took the body and wrapped it in a clean linen cloth ⁶⁰ and laid it in his own new tomb, which he had cut out in the rock. Then he rolled a large stone against the door of the tomb, and departed.

Joseph had already prepared a new tomb for himself. He likely thought it was for his own future—but God had another plan. Sometimes God has you build something in one season that He'll use for a completely different purpose later.

Reflection Question:

Is there something you've been learning, building, or doing that God might be preparing to use in a way you don't see yet?

Bite 2 – Courage to Be Counted, John 19:38–39

³⁸ After these things, Joseph of Arimathea, being a disciple of Jesus, but secretly for fear of the Jews, asked of Pilate that he might take away Jesus' body. Pilate gave him permission. He came therefore and took away his body. ³⁹ Nicodemus, who at first came to Jesus by night, also came bringing a mixture of myrrh and aloes, about a hundred Roman pounds

Joseph and Nicodemus were secret disciples that gave Jesus a burial of honor, even when it looked like everything was over. They chose reverence when others might have chosen to walk away in disappointment. Sometimes God sends the unlikeliest people to assist you in your transition. Both men stepped out of the shadows to align themselves with a "condemned" Messiah.

Check-in:

Can you think on a time when your faith honored God even when you don't understand what He's doing?

Bite 3 – Faith Sealed in Stone, John 19:40–42

So they took Jesus' body, and bound it in linen cloths with the spices, as the custom of the Jews is to bury. Now in the place where he was crucified there was a garden. In the garden was a new tomb in which no man had ever yet been laid. Then because of the Jews' Preparation Day (for the tomb was near at hand) they laid Jesus there.

The stone and the sealed tomb looked like a "Game Over" screen, but they were actually the setup for the greatest comeback in history. Joseph's obedience in preparing that tomb became the physical evidence the world needed to prove the resurrection was real. Just when you think a situation is buried and finished, remember God is in the details, and your "prep work" matters more than you know.

Author's Commentary

Sometimes the prompt feels "silly," but obedience is the key to a chain of events only God can see. While stationed in Guantanamo Bay, Cuba, I felt a sudden urge at the altar to hug and speak life to a sister who was hurting. In my head, it felt random, but I chose to move anyway.

I didn't know that another woman in the service, Sister Williams, had just challenged God for a sign that He was still listening. She actually had a vision of me hugging that sister before I even stood up. Because I didn't let my "lack of action" get in the way, a chain reaction happened: the sister at the altar received comfort, and Williams received the divine confirmation she desperately needed. One "silly" step of faith can be the answer to someone else's secret prayer.

 Reflection Question:

Where in your life does it feel like a “stone” has been rolled in place—and how might God surprise you there?

 Dessert – Trusting What You Can’t See Yet

Joseph didn’t see the resurrection when he rolled the stone; he just saw a moment that required his faithfulness. We often think we need the full blueprint before we move, but we don’t have to see or know the whole plan for it to work out for our good. We just have to trust the One who does.

We know in part and see in part, but the more we lean into the God who sees the end from the beginning, the more fulfilling our story becomes.

 Reflection Prompt:

Write a one-sentence prayer:

“Lord, help me trust You with _____, even when I can’t see the outcome yet.”

 To-Go Box

- Quiet obedience still matters in God’s kingdom.
 - God can use what you’ve prepared in ways you didn’t expect.
 - What looks like closure to you may be a setup for God’s breakthrough.
-

 Prayer

“Lord, thank You for Joseph’s example of humble, quiet courage. Help me to obey You even when it feels like no one is watching, and to trust that You are working behind the scenes. Use what I’ve prepared and built for Your purposes, not just my own ideas. In Jesus’ name, amen.”



Personal Prayer Space

Write a prayer asking God to use your gifts, resources, and preparation for His purpose:



Activity – Connect the Process

Match each act of faith with the result it connects to.

Match		Acts of Faith		Results
	1	Joseph asked Pilate for Jesus' body.	A	What looked like a final seal set the stage for resurrection.
	2	Joseph rolled the stone across the entrance of the tomb.	B	A personal tomb became part of God's big redemption story.
	3	Joseph had prepared his own new tomb.	C	The burial honored Jesus and fulfilled Jewish custom and prophecy.
	4	Joseph wrapped Jesus' body in clean linen with spices.	D	Jesus' body was placed in a tomb of honor instead of being discarded.

Appendix – Breakfast Month 3 (YE) Answer Key

Theme: Faith & Foresight – Youth Edition

Lesson 1 – Rahab: Faith That Took Action

Activity – True or False: Rahab’s Faith

1. Rahab was an Israelite woman raised in a godly home.
➤ False – She was a Canaanite woman from Jericho.
2. The scarlet rope was a sign of the agreement between Rahab and the spies.
➤ True
3. Rahab’s actions showed both faith in God and concern for her family.
➤ True
4. Rahab’s faith only affected her, not anyone else.
➤ False – Her whole household was saved.
5. Rahab is later mentioned in the family line of Jesus.
➤ True – She appears in His genealogy.

Lesson 2 – Abigail: Wisdom on the Move

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. Abigail acted with wisdom and **faith**, not fear.
2. Nabal’s pride led to his **death**.
3. David praised God for Abigail’s **good sense/wisdom**.
4. Abigail’s wisdom prevented **bloodshed/vengeance** and brought peace.

Lesson 3 – The Centurion: Faith That Commands Results

Activity – Fill in the Blank

1. The centurion’s faith worked even at a **distance**.
2. Jesus said, “I have not found anyone in Israel with such great **faith**.”
3. True faith doesn’t need evidence; it trusts the **Word**.
4. The centurion understood the power of **authority**.

Lesson 4 – Joseph of Arimathea: Trust the Process

Activity – Connect the Process

Match		Acts of Faith		Results
D	1	Joseph asked Pilate for Jesus' body.	A	What looked like a final seal set the stage for resurrection.
A	2	Joseph rolled the stone across the entrance of the tomb.	B	A personal tomb became part of God's big redemption story.
B	3	Joseph had prepared his own new tomb.	C	The burial honored Jesus and fulfilled Jewish custom and prophecy.
C	4	Joseph wrapped Jesus' body in clean linen with spices.	D	Jesus' body was placed in a tomb of honor instead of being discarded.

CREDITS & ACKNOWLEDGEMENTS

Creator, Soul Food Series

Dr. Shefa “Dee” Brown, MBAE, MSIT, DD

Contact & Orders

For booking inquiries: overflowharvest@gmail.com

For bulk orders: kingdomlivingproject2020@gmail.com

Evangelist Rose Doctor

Email: redroseofgrace@gmail.com

Major Ministry Contributors

Dr. Temia Joy Julius

CEO, Temia Joy’s Events and Consulting

Email: temiajoyevents@gmail.com

TikTok: [@temiajoy](https://www.tiktok.com/@temiajoy)

Pastor Michael Edwards II .

Email: michael.edwards2@yahoo.com

TikTok: [@dopestpastor](https://www.tiktok.com/@dopestpastor)

Faith Destiny Helpers

With heartfelt gratitude to the following “Destiny Helpers” whose prayers, encouragement, advocacy, and support helped birth and sustain this work:

- **Co-Pastor Johnetta Baymon**, Deliverance Center Ministries COGIC
- **James R. Johnson**, COO, Pearl Development Group, Inc.
- **Apostle Linda Edwards**, Overseer, Kingdom Revelation International Ministries
- **Jafari O. Brown**, IT Web DevOps Consultant
- **Mother Vicki Frisby**, IT Consultant
- **Sandra Gethers**, My ‘843’ Sounding Board
- **Min. Crystal Green**, Intercessor
- **Simpson L. Doctor**, *Poet* “Prayer for Divine Connection”
- **The AD, ZB, LDH** and morethank you!

Music & Media Credits

With appreciation to the ministers and creatives whose gifts in music and media help carry this message beyond the page:

- JNR Robinson, *Never Knew*, (2010)
- Harold Lee, *We All We Got* - Feat. Streetz Young, Elicia Dunston, (2023)
- Apostle Linda Edwards, *Three in One*, (2023)
- Kossi Bruno, *A Friend*, (2019)
- Man CJ - Mr. “Man Like Me” -my musical brother-in-love

Wellness Support Team

Charleston Wellness Center – thank you for reminding us that spiritual work flourishes best when mind, body, and soul are cared for together.

Editors

To my editors – including the gifted freelancers who labored behind their online pen names – thank you for your attentive eyes, patient revisions, and for helping me carry the heart of this message with clarity and excellence. Your quiet, faithful work is felt on every page.

Reference & Study Resources

Historical, linguistic, and cultural insights for the instructors and teachers- extended study materials have been formed by standard biblical reference works, concordances, and reputable academic sources, as outlined in the Reference & Historical Source Index (Instructor Edition) for this series. These tools were used under educational Fair Use to provide context, clarity, and enrichment for teachers and students alike.

FaithTech & Digital Tools

Special thanks to the emerging world of FaithTech and “greater works” digital tools that helped make this project possible at a fraction of the traditional cost, multiplying reach while honoring the message of the Gospel.

Above all, I give glory to God for every person, prayer, tool, and resource that has helped turn Soul Food from a vision into a living, teaching ministry on the page.

Why Soul Food?



Dr. Dee Brown
Series Founder

Growing up in Boston, my grandmother, Pastor Pearl Doctor, **always brought both the food and the Word to the table.** You couldn't walk into her home without smelling something cooking and hearing something spiritual on the radio. Whether you came in upset, excited, nervous, or afraid, she would bring you back to center—with the Word of God in one hand and a plate of food in the other.

She didn't wait until Sunday to offer support. She lived what I now call: ***Truth Served Daily***—sharing God's Word like Heavenly bread alongside whatever she had on the stove. I watched family, and friends, alike find peace in that kind of soul food, the kind that nourishes the inner person and prepares us for more than the moment we're in.

This Soul Food Bible Study workbook was born from that legacy. Designed for **personal devotion or Bible study circles, use in cell group ministry, and Sunday school settings**, each lesson offers bite-sized, life-giving “courses” to help you grow in wholeness, deepen fellowship, and share what God is doing in you with others. My hope is that these pages bring comfort, clarity, and courage—and inspire you to pass that soul food along. Be blessed!



OVERFLOW HARVEST, LLC: SOUL FOOD BREAK*FAST,
YOUTH EDITION ALL RIGHTS RESERVED © 2025